

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

The first system of the musical score is in 4/4 time with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). It features a treble and bass staff. The melody is primarily in the treble staff, with the bass staff providing harmonic support. The lyrics are aligned with the notes, showing four different versions of the first line of the song.

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The second system continues the melody and harmony. It includes a repeat sign at the end of the phrase, indicating a return to the beginning of the system.

In my heart, in my heart,

In my heart, In my heart,

The third system features a melodic line with a long note value (likely a half note or whole note) and a bass line with a long note value. The lyrics are repeated twice, with a comma after 'heart'.

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

The fourth system concludes the piece with a final melodic phrase and a bass line. It includes a repeat sign at the end, indicating a return to the beginning of the system.